

Moreover, OpenSolaris has many unique features, which are not available on any flavour of Linux. For example, while Linux uses Ext3 or Ext4 file systems, OpenSolaris uses the ZFS file system which is a much more advanced file system. We will discuss ZFS in greater detail later in the book. OpenSolaris also provides developer tools like DTrace, which allow programmers and system administrators to probe the inner functioning of an applications while it is still running. DTrace will be covered in details as well.

Differences between Linux and OpenSolaris exists in licensing as well. While Linux is released under the GNU Public License (GPL), OpenSolaris is released under Common Development and Distribution License (CDDL). CDDL is based on Mozilla Public License (MPL) and unlike GPL, which is a project based license, CDDL is a file based license. This allows users and developers a greater level of freedom and permits both closed source as well as open source components to co-exist in the same project.

OpenSolaris is very different from the operating systems of the Microsoft Windows family. As stated earlier, unlike Windows, OpenSolaris is free and open source. Even though it is possible to run some of the applications developed for Windows using WINE, OpenSolaris and Windows are different in most of the technological aspects.

1.3 Key features

OpenSolaris provides many unmatched features in almost every aspect of its use.

For a Desktop User: If you want to use OpenSolaris as a desktop operating system, here are some features which would make many things simple and possible.

Image Packaging System (IPS): Finding, installing and managing applications has never been easier. The Image Packaging System allows users to search applications and safely install them without hassles from various software repositories online. It is also possible to set up local software repositories over a standalone machine or over any local area network (LAN) infrastructure.

Time Slider: Timeslider is a unique feature of OpenSolaris. By utilizing the capabilities of the underlying ZFS file system, Timeslider automatically keeps taking regular snapshots of your files and allows you to access files which you might have deleted or changed just by click of a button.

Device Driver Utility: OpenSolaris Device Driver Utility scans all the hardware and peripheral devices attached to the system and alerts the